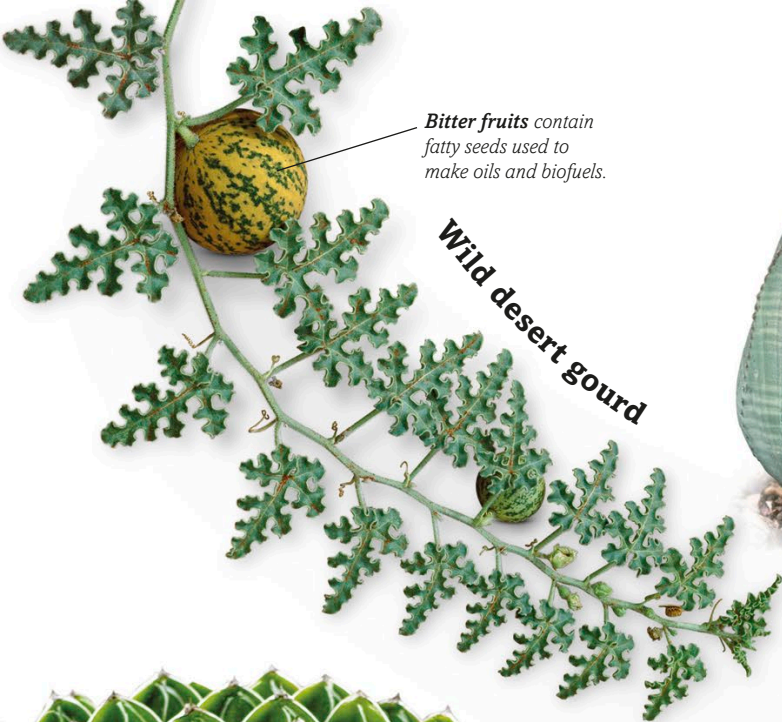




Bitter fruits contain fatty seeds used to make oils and biofuels.

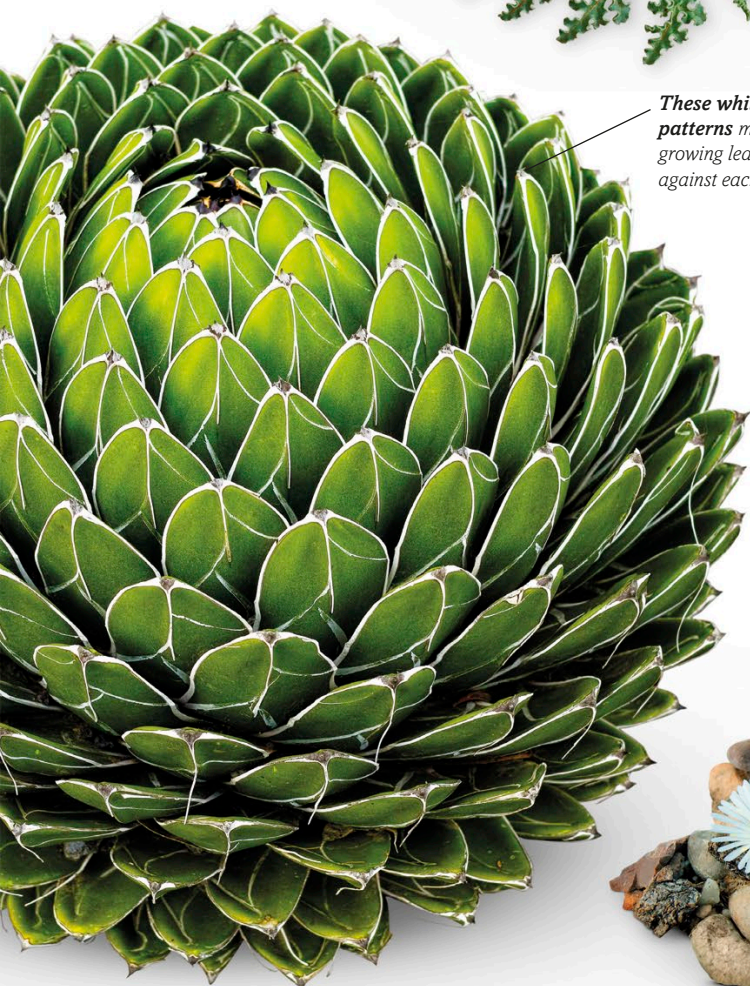
Wild desert gourd



The fleshy stem makes food for the plant by photosynthesis.

Baseball plant

Now **protected** by law, baseball plants nearly went **extinct** due to overcollecting.



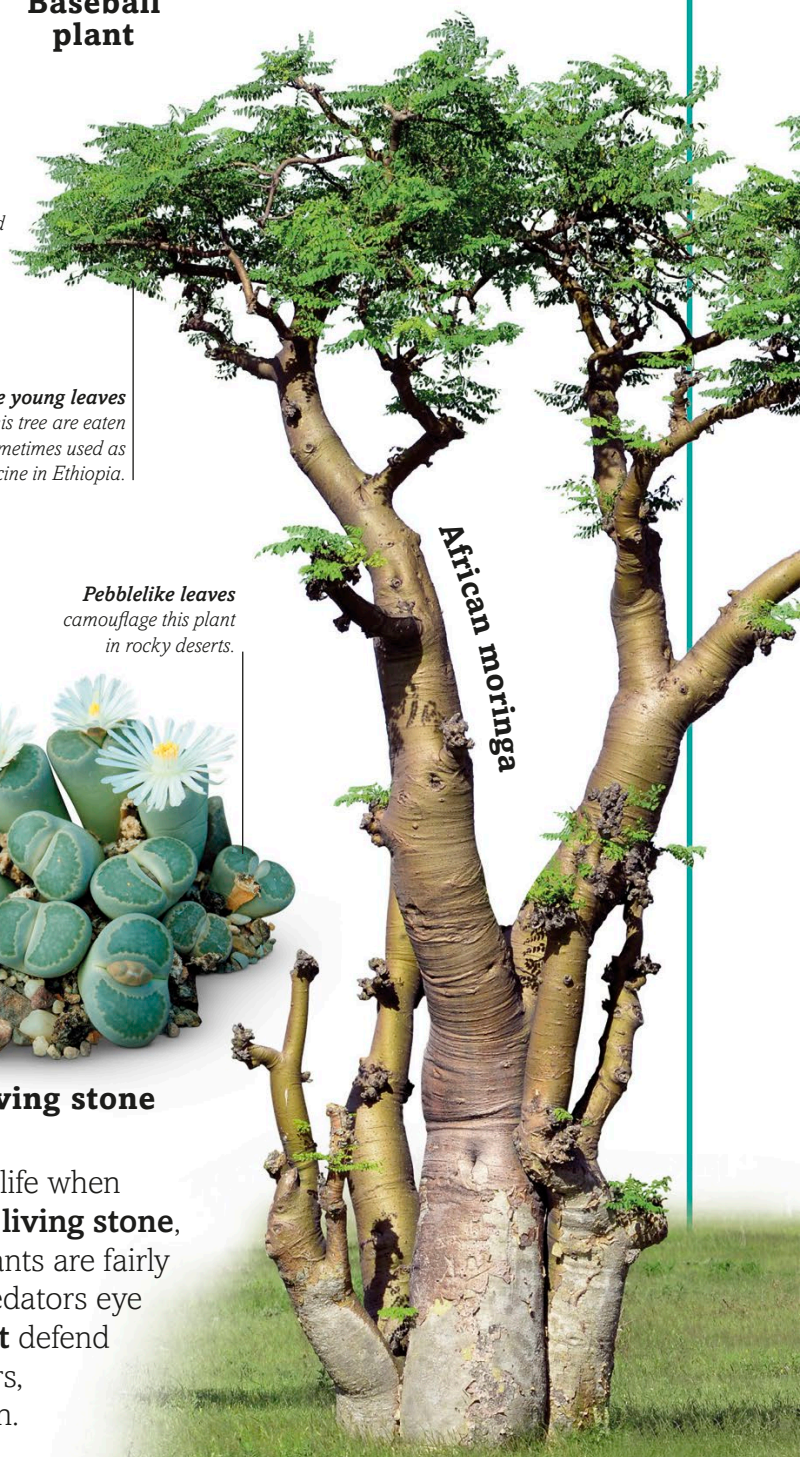
These white patterns mark where growing leaves pushed against each other.

Queen Victoria agave



Pebblelike leaves camouflage this plant in rocky deserts.

Living stone



African moringa

like this for several years but quickly comes back to life when rain soaks its leaves. Like cacti, the **baseball plant**, **living stone**, and **African moringa** store water in their stems. Plants are fairly uncommon in deserts and semideserts, so many predators eye them hungrily. The **camel thorn** and **century plant** defend themselves using sharp thorns or spines, while others, including the **llareta**, protect themselves with poison.

